

↓ FRAMEWORK

14 Ways Multi-Agent Systems Actually Break

And why a bigger context window will not fix it

01 Your team copies data between systems daily

02 Decisions wait on a person, not data

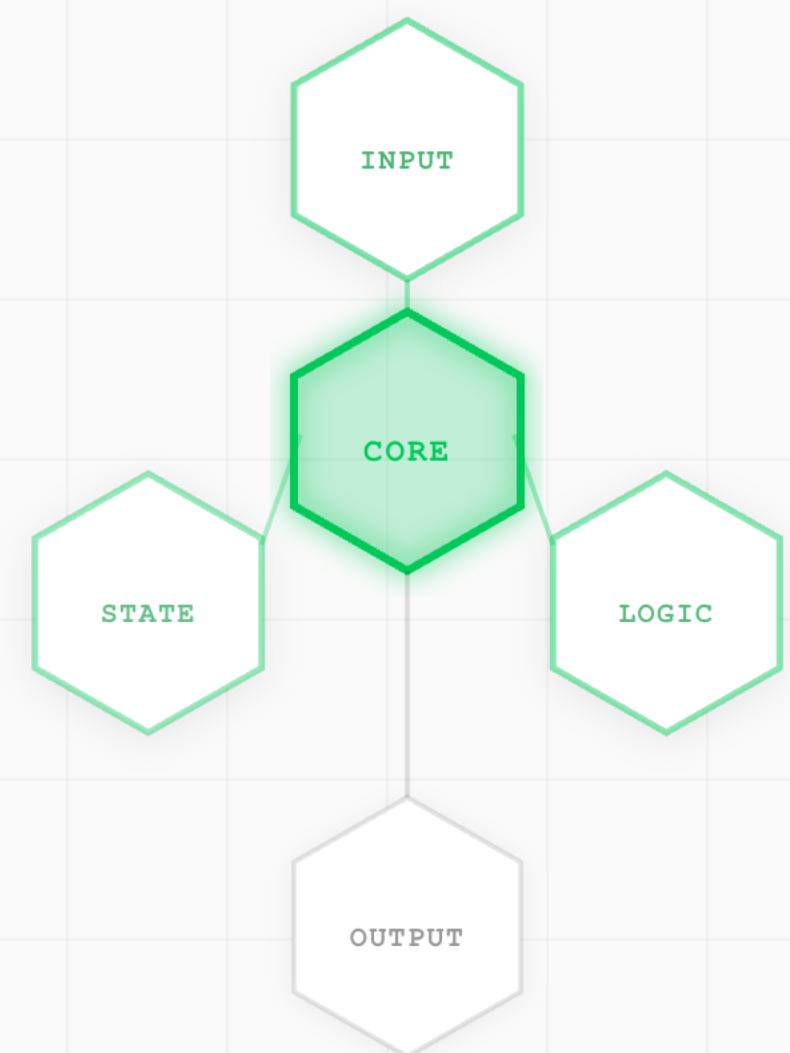
03 You've automated tasks but not workflows

IF YES TO ANY →
You need an agent, not another app.

□

2 Berkeley studied 1,600-plus failure traces across seven frameworks

Most failures were coordination and specification problems, not model capability problems.

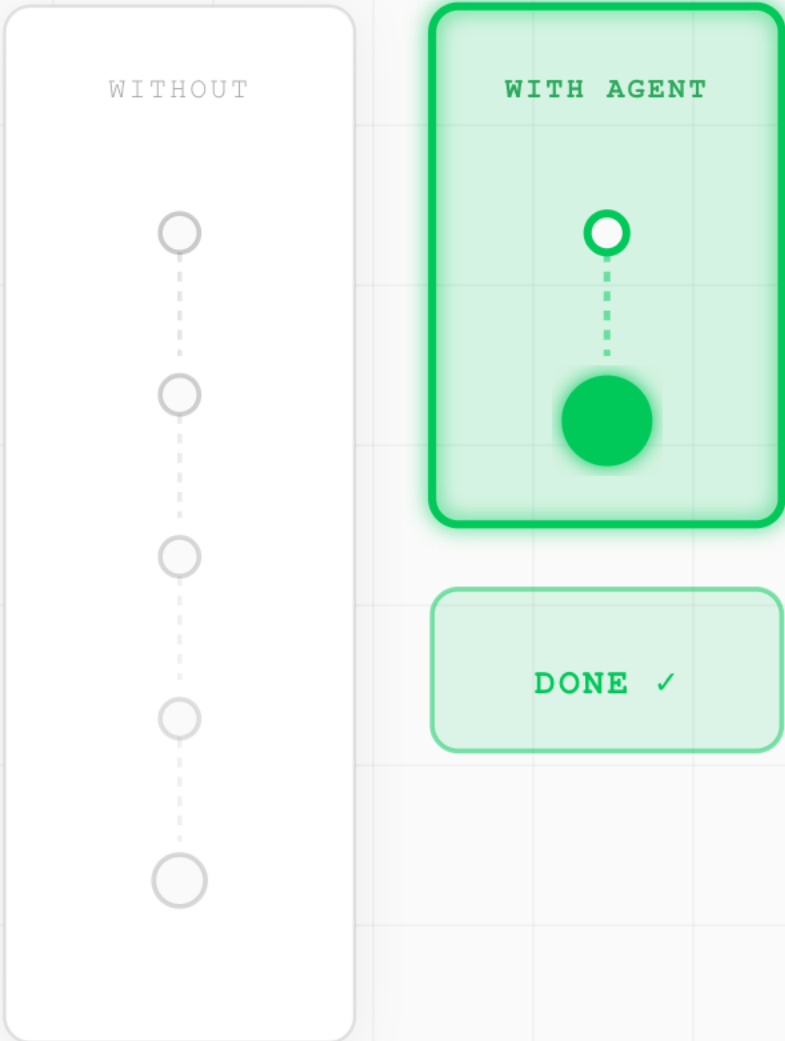


SYS.NODES

□

3 A 1M-token window helps one agent hold more state

That's real. But most failures happen at the seam between two agents, not inside either one's reasoning.

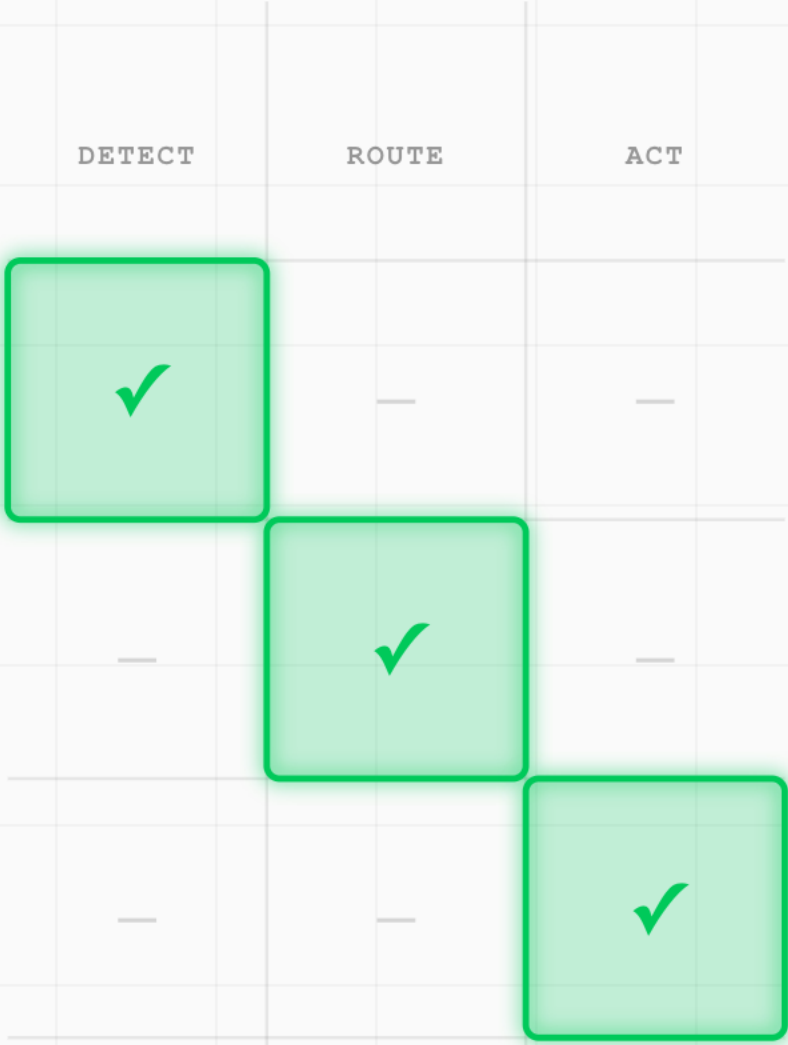


COMPARISON

□

4 One vague handoff instruction, two different executed plans

Both agents confident. Both wrong in different directions. The model was never the problem.



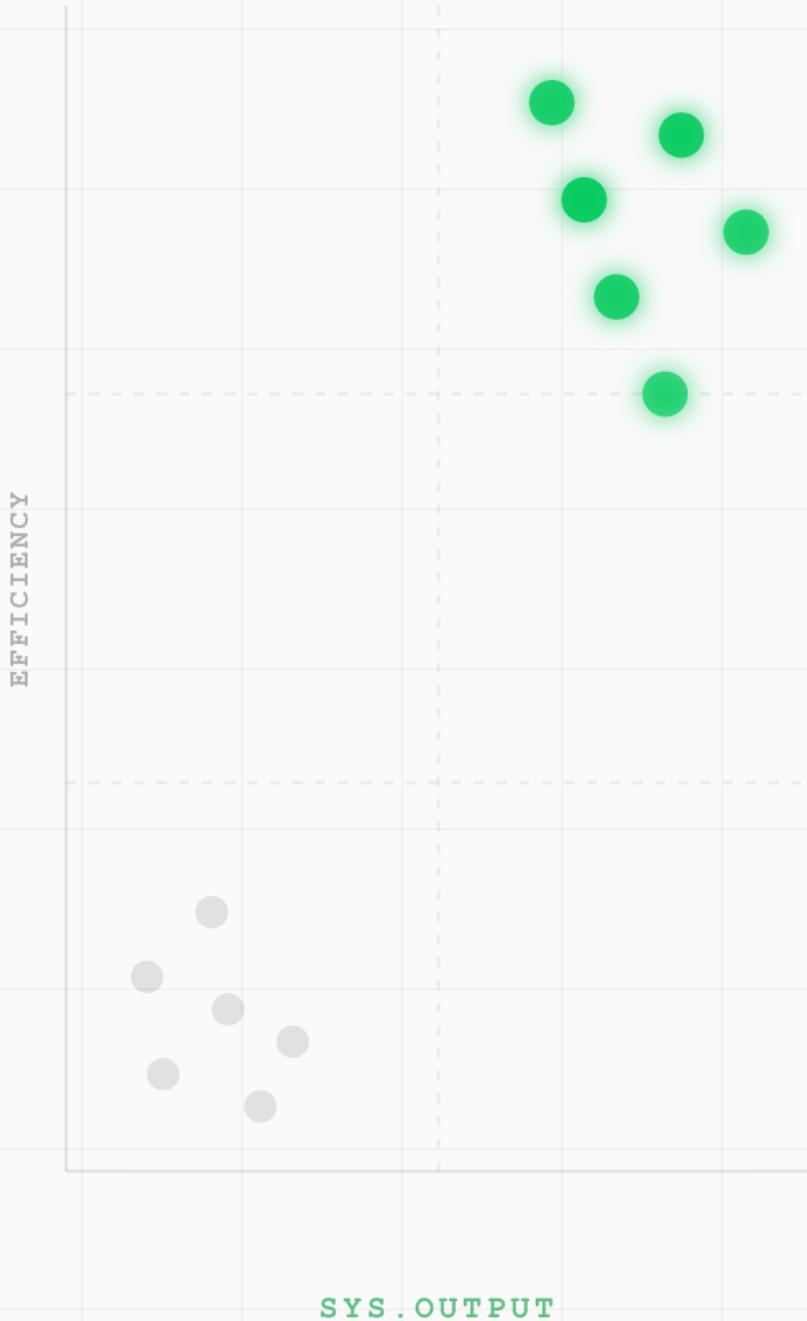
DECISION.MAP

0

5

Handoff latency past 30 seconds is a warning sign

Usually means the receiving agent is
struggling to parse what it was handed, not
that it's undersized.



□

6 I fixed a client system by rewriting the handoff contract

Not the model. The instruction couldn't be read two ways after the rewrite.



EXEC.BRIEF / AI INFRASTRUCTURE



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Check your handoffs before you check your context window

ARHEM